Don't Buy Strange Swords from Junk Shops

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/68597656.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - High School, Fake ID, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Adora is a Dork (She-Ra), POV Adora (She-Ra), Humor, discord prompt, Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Modern AU, Magicat Catra (She-Ra)

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Part 1 of SPOP Discord Prompts

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Don't Buy Strange Swords from Junk Shops

by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

"You're a giant woman... Why are you a giant woman!"

"I- I don't know!"

"What the hell, Adora?!

"You think I chose this superpower? Don't think I'd rather have, like, the ability to fly or super speed... or... or something?!"

Adora buys a sword from Old Razz's junk shop. After Catra notices from ancient writing on the blade, Adora reads it, a weird phrase and then-- Poof! She's suddenly taller. Her hair now glistens in the sun. And she's dressed in gold and white!

(Based off the prompt "You think I chose this superpower? Don't you think I'd rather have, like, the ability to fly or something?" on Discord)

Notes

I've been working on this one-shot off and on for a bit. I'm excited to finally have it off my Google Docs and on AO3!! Hopefully ya'll enjoy it! I'm on the SPOP Creative Flex Discord server and they do a weekly prompt! I'm way behind but I'm hoping to eventually get all the prompts I'm interested in written out and published for ya'll to read and (hopefully) enjoy!

A very special thank you to Lyssa for beta-reading!

See the end of the work for more notes

Hurried footsteps pounded against the sidewalk. The silver metal of a sword glistened under the bright sunny sky. Houses, neat and nice and relatively new, passed by in a blur. Reds, blues, even greens and tans… On either side of her, flashed by in a blurred blink.

It was one the newer neighborhoods in the Bright Moon; built just within the last decade. Although most of the newer neighborhoods were what Catra often called "cookie cutter", they all looked the same and were typically just painted a simple and dull brown, this neighborhood (and even some of the ones near it), were more colorful and the designs were more varied.

Most of the people who lived in this particular neighborhood opted to go with customized homes, each built to their specific needs or simply wants. Some were simple single-story starter homes. Others were much larger and more elaborate. They were two stories tall, some with tall or large windows and long, wooden porches, reminding her a lot of the homes in Bright Moon's old and rundown historical district.

Most of those houses were in shambles, and they had been as long as Adora could remember. The paint had been peeling and was faded from age, sun and weather exposure. Windows were boarded up, or they were protected by sheets of tin foil that reflected the sunlight right back at the street.

Her old neighborhood.

Her new place was nice, very nice. The houses were still new and shiny, with yards well maintained and manicured. Catra's new neighborhood seemed even nicer than hers, despite being just three blocks away.

Adora continued her sprint. A dark red backpack, thumping against her back, the contents inside clanging and shuffling loudly. Her ponytail bounced between her shoulder blades. A sword in her hand.

She could hear the hum of a lawnmower further up. It was a little faint, probably being used on a lawn some houses down across the street. She couldn't see it, not yet, but she could already smell the fresh and earthy scent of freshly cut grass and the familiar, nostalgic, and oddly comforting stench of gasoline.

It brought back memories from her early childhood. Memories of a time that, although not the best years of her life, had *some* fond moments. Her and Catra hanging out in their neighbor's yard. "Helping" their neighbor (one of the first positive adult figures in their young lives) fix the old, busted, and oftentimes, rust-covered cars that seemed to be permanently parked *in* her yard and driveway.

Well… "helping" was a loose term. Usually, her and Catra just sat somewhere nearby. They would watch Huntara as she disassembled and reassembled cars. They learned how to check oil, what the tools were, all while asking the woman endless questions. All day on the weekends and most evenings, as soon as homework was done.

Through the two years Adora and Catra had known her, Huntara had asked them a lot of questions. And suddenly, new people had started coming to their home. Adults in suits and nice clothes. First it was only every month. They would be taken aside and asked questions about how happy they were, if they felt safe, and fed. Rarely was it the same person… Until their last six months in that house.

One woman kept coming back. With raven black hair, a smile and kind eyes. She had said that her name was Castaspella and she came by every month for a bit. Then every two weeks. And finally every week.

She had a warmth to her. One that her and Catra's caretaker during that time, Ms. Weaver didn't. Soon enough, everything changed. And it changed *fast*.

Adora was now living with Castaspella's brother, sister-in-law, and niece. And Catra was now living with her foster sister's best friend, Bow, just a few blocks away. Although neither of them had wanted to be separated, so far, everything had worked out. They had been with their respective new families for two years now and they both felt settled. *Safe*.

Adora continued her mad sprint through Catra's neighborhood. She had been running for awhile now, excited to show Catra her latest junkshop find. A part of her knew that she was probably gonna scold her for it. Catra was probably gonna question why she would use a fake ID on a sword. A fake ID Catra had worked so hard to procure for her, after spending weeks trying to convince Adora to get one.

She could practically *hear* the exasperated sigh. She could practically see the scowl on Catra's face.

On Catra's list of reasons *why* they should get a fake ID, buying a sword was low on the list. Actually, buying a sword wasn't even *on* the list. Catra had laughed in her face when she had suggested using it to buy a fish from the pet store. The laughter (a musical-like sound that Adora always longed to hear) soon died out and when Adora explained that she was serious, and came up with a name and possible custody arrangement for the fish, Catra's face flashed from amusement to disappointment at her lack of rebellion.

Still though, *Swift Wind the fish*, did make it to the list of things they would use the fake ID for. It was low on the list but still, a win was a win.

Her fingers were wrapped tightly around the golden hilt of the sword. The blue oval jewel flashed, reflecting the bright, overbearing sun above her. Thin beads of sweat dripped down her forehead and neck. Although it was late spring, it already felt more like the hot, dog days of summer.

Adora didn’t slow. She was so close to Catra’s now. Just four or five houses away! She cast a quick glance at the sword. She still couldn’t believe that the old lady, Razz, had actually sold it to her. Or that the sword was in her price-range.

She had been on her way to Catra’s after her soccer practice. Usually, either Angella or Micah would pick her up from the practice and drive her to Catra’s but the two of them were out of town for the day. Neither she nor Glimmer were old enough to drive yet. Both of them were supposed to start the process of getting their permits during the summer, after school ended.

Catra’s guardians were gone today as well. Otherwise she could have asked one of them to pick her up, or rather, Angella or Micah would have. She didn’t mind though. She figured the walk (well, run now) would help her with conditioning.

Catra’s house was in view now! A large grin broke across Adora’s face. Somehow, she turned her speed up a notch then. Her energy, once depleted and fading, was refilled, and she booked it to the familiar blue paneled house.

She turned and sprinted down their lawn. She jumped up to the porch, completely ignoring the three concrete steps that would’ve taken her up. She ran up to the front door and pounded on the door with her right fist. Her left hand still gripped the sword tightly.

An excited smile was on her face. Sure, Catra wasn’t as big a sword fanatic as she was. Catra didn’t spend hours researching swordings, watching videos of sword training or even practiced with a crappily (but lovingly) homemade sword when she was a little kid. But still, Catra did find swords cool! And maybe, just maybe, she would be proud of Adora for using that fake ID. Maybe Adora wouldn’t be *just* her childhood friend in her eyes then. Maybe– The front door swung up. Adora’s fist was held up still, mid-knock.

Catra was standing in the doorway. Her ear flickered in annoyance, her tail lazily waving behind her. Her mane was messy, as if she had just been awoken from a deep sleep. Knowing Catra, that was a possibility. She seemed to love 'cat naps'. And her new bedroom was positioned just perfectly for sunbeams. Adora noted that the sun was in that perfect spot now, just enough that it *should* be around that time when Catra's favorite sunbeam hit her bed.

There was a mild look of irritation on Catra's face. Adora gave her an awkward, apologic smile.

"You're late," Catra deadpanned. Her tail whipped behind her.

Adora wanted to apologize. She wanted to come up with some cocky, smug, smart-ass reply. Instead of either of those responses though, she just awkwardly moved her left hand and angled the sword so that the flat on the blade was between her and Catra.

"Sword," Adora said lamely, still grinning away like an absolute idiot. She was able to be cool around her teammates. She was able to appear *somewhat* suave to her classmates. So why then was she always awkward and so uncool around Catra?

She watched as Catra's gaze flickered to the sword. A curious light shimmered in her eyes then.

"Where did you…?" Her words faded into silence.

"Razz's junkshop!" Adora supplied, excitedly. Try as she might, she couldn't keep her unbridled joy away. She had bought a sword… A *real* sword!

"Old Lady Razz just sold you a sword?" Catra asked, glancing at Adora once more. Adora felt her heart skip a beat. She swore her face was flushing under Catra's mismatched gaze.

"Well, I had to use the fake ID. But–" Catra's snicker cut her off. It prompted a soft smile to touch Adora's lips then. She waited for Catra's laughter to die down. But before she could continue–

"Old Razz has known us– Known *you* for years now! How did you even get the fake ID past her?" She leaned against the doorway, her arms folding across her chest. A smug smile now on her lips. Her eyes closed for a moment.

"She must have taken pity on you," she said an exaggerated sigh.

"No! She took the ID! She looked it over and everything!" Adora hurriedly explained.

Catra *tsked* and shook her head.

"Nah… Razz felt sorry for you," she said, a smirk on her lips and a mischievous glint in her eyes, "Only reason she accepted it."

"Oh come on!" Adora shot back. Her face reddened. She could be a rule-breaker like Catra if she wanted to!

"That's totally not–" She thought back to her encounter with Razz at the old junk shop. The old woman had greeted her excitedly. For once, she had called her by her name and not *Mara*. Whoever Mara was… She assumed that Mara was Razz's daughter.

She wondered what happened to her. Maybe she had moved away. Or maybe she had died. But for some reason, Razz constantly called her Mara… Except for today.

"Aww…" Catra stepped closer to Adora. She reached around Adora's back, putting a hand on the opposite shoulder. She pulled Adora in close, almost tucking her into her embrace, Adora noted.

She fought to keep the annoyed look on her face, or at least to keep it neutral. She wasn't about to let Catra win this argument, not if she could help it.

"What's wrong? Realized I'm right?" Catra teased, flashing Adora her trademark, mischievous grin.

Adora closed her eyes and huffed in annoyance. Catra pulled out of the tight embrace. Her fingers brushed Adora's shoulder as she

took a step away, turning to face Adora once more.

“Anyway,” Catra began, her gaze on the sword, “That is a cool sword.”

Adora opened her eyes and returned Catra’s smile. It wasn’t *as* mischievous as Catra’s.

“What’s that?” Catra asked, suddenly.

“What’s what?” Adora asked, her eyebrows furrowed in confusion. Catra was staring at the sword. Her tail flickering behind her in a way that reminded her of the rare occasions she would raise her hand and ask a question in class.

Catra pointed at the sword. Why was she pointing at the sword? Adora followed her finger. Okay, so Catra was pointing at the blade itself. But why was she… Adora’s eyes widened. Etched into the steel of the blade itself were symbols! Strange symbols. Symbols she couldn’t recall ever seeing before.

She brought the sword closer. Her gaze set on the strange, perhaps arcane symbols, curiously. The symbols… Wait! Those weren’t symbols, she realized. Those were *words*!

For the honor of… What did it say? Did that say, *Greyskull*?

“I know that look,” Catra’s voice cut through her thoughts like a knife.
Adora cast a glance at Catra.

“Do you know what it is?” Catra asked.

Adora looked at the blade once again.

“I think it’s… words?”

Catra stepped closer. She reached out, a finger on the flat of the blade. She traced one of the symbols– words, with her finger.

“Hate to tell you, ‘dor, but these don’t look like words,” she said smugly.

“They are.”

“Then what does it say?” Catra asked with a smirk.

“For the honor of Greyskull.”

A bright, blinding light shone from the blade. It bathed them both in its light. Adora couldn’t see Catra. She couldn’t see the front door.

Poof!

Adora opened her eyes. Hesitantly. Slowly. They were screwed shut. Why had she closed them? She didn’t remember doing that. She remembered a blinding light. She remembered saying some words.

For the honor of Greyskull!

What the fuck was Greyskull? She couldn’t recall ever hearing that word before. Or was Greyskull a name? Maybe it was a *place*? Either way, she wasn’t going to figure that out right now. Maybe Razz knew?

Catra was staring at her. Her eyes wide. Her mouth was agape. Her tail was still. It was rarely still. Why was it still?

Adora suddenly became very aware that she was staring *down* at Catra. Sure, she was taller than Catra, but only by a few inches. She swore that Catra seemed a couple of *feet* shorter than her now.

“Wh-what happened?!” Catra’s panicked voice broke through her thoughts.

Adora dropped the sword like it was on fire. It fell to the floor with a *clang*. A bright light consumed her again and then flickered out

like the flame on a candle wick. Adora lost her footing. She fell into a sitting position on the floor.

Catra was staring at her. Her mismatched eyes were wide. Her tail was puffed up and thrashing behind her. Her ears were pinned back. Slowly, her ears moved back up. Her tail continued to thrash though, and it was still puffed up.

She stepped forward, thrusted a hand out for Adora to grab and pulled her up once the blonde accepted it.

"Thanks," Adora murmured as she was pulled to her feet.

She felt Catra's tail brush against her arm. It wasn't *as* puffed up now, Adora noted, though it was still a little bigger than it usually was. Catra released her hand and pulled it back. Adora frowned a little at the lack of contact. Maybe it was the warmth she missed? Catra always said that *she* was like a furnace, always running hot. More than once, Catra had cited that as the reason why she would cuddle up next to her whenever they would sit on the bus during the bitter winter mornings.

"Alright… What… What happened?" Catra repeated, eyeing the dropped sword wearily. Her tail puffed up again. It wasn't *quite* thrashing. But it wasn't exactly still either.

"I… I don't…" Adora stammered in a panic. Catra glanced up at her, their eyes met. Her brow furrowed and Adora could see the question in Catra's worried gaze: *Are you alright?<\i>*

Her and Catra rarely needed words to communicate. Somehow she could always tell what Catra was thinking with just a quick glance at her face. And likewise, Catra always seemed to know what was going on in Adora's mind, sometimes it seemed like even before Adora herself had realized it.

"I… I think I'm… fine…?" She cringed internally. The worried look on Catra's face didn't fade.

Why did she phrase it like a question? Stupid! She should've sounded more confident with her answer! She was fine! Well, mostly fine. She felt slightly tired. A faint, dim drain.

Catra's gaze flickered back to the sword. She stepped closer to the fallen blade. She knelt down and then plucked the sword up off the ground. She turned it curiously, studying the strange language etched on the steel.

"What was that you said?" Catra asked suddenly, her attention still fully on the sword. The blue jewel glistened. Adora stared at it, barely registering what Catra had said. For some reason, she felt a strange… energy<\i> seeping out of the jewel. Did Catra feel it too?

"What?"

"Those words… What were they again?" Catra asked, slower this time.

The words! What were the words again? Adora looked away from the jewel. She couldn't remember the actual phrase. She caught sight of the words again and read them aloud, "For the honor of Greyskull…?"

Adora frowned. Her gaze never left the arcane symbols.

"What's Greyskull?" She wondered aloud. A part of her also wondered why nothing strange had happened this<\i> time.

Had she imagined it? No! Catra had seen it too! They couldn't both imagine the same thing! Right…?

A feral grin spread across Catra's face. An air of mischievousness surrounded her. Seriously, how did she do that?!

Catra thrusted the sword to the sky— well, ceiling, and in a firm (maybe even heroic?) voice, called out, "For the honor of Greyskull!"

Adora closed her eyes in anticipation. She felt the strange energy shimmering from the sword and then— Nothing. It vanished as quickly as it had appeared.

Adora hesitantly opened her eyes. Catra was standing before her, sword still pointing skyward. A scowl formed on Catra's face. Her tail and ears twitched.

Catra didn't look any different? She didn't seem taller. Adora wondered if anything else had changed about her. She remembered the sudden height gain. She had faint memories of white and gold…

Catra thrusted the sword up again. A frustrated growl escaped her.

"For the honor of Greyskull!" She called out again. Nothing happened.

"What the hell?!" Catra groaned angrily, bringing the sword down and glaring at it.

She flashed Adora a quick scowl and then practically shoved the hilt into her hands.

"You try it!" Catra demanded, her fangs flashing dangerously.

Adora pointed the blade up again and repeated the words. A flash of light, too blinding and too bright. She was tall again. Startled, she dropped the sword again and reverted back.

"What the hell, Adora?!"

"What do you mean, 'what the hell'?!" Adora shot back. She had no idea what was going on and now Catra was frustrated with her? If Catra had no idea what had happened, then would she?!

"You bought some strange-ass sword and now you turn into a giant lady?!"

"You think I chose this?" Adora demanded with a huff. What even was this? She had chosen to buy the sword. That much was true! But the blinding light? The transformation? The strange letters on the blade? She hadn't chosen any of that!

What was this? For the honor of Greyskull and then poof! Change into a giant woman? Was it like those cheesy movies Bow seemed to like? For whatever reason, Bow was big into the superhero movies. Micah was too. It gave the two of them something to bond over.

"Lamest super power ever," she heard Catra mutter beside her. Seriously, how did Catra always seem to know just what she was thinking? For some reason, that phrase struck a nerve. She hadn't chosen this! Sure! She bought the sword but it wasn't like she knew the sword would do this!

"Don't you think I would've chosen to… to fly! Or… Or… I don't know! Super speed! Or strength! Or… Or…! Something else?!"

Adora sighed in frustration. She glanced away from Catra, so she missed how quickly the scowl faded from Catra's face. She didn't see the concern in Catra's eyes as she watched Adora carefully. She did feel Catra's hand on her shoulder though and because of that, she looked back up at the magicat. Catra gave her a small, thin smile.

"Alright, we'll take the sword and go back to Razz's. Together." Adora didn't miss the way Catra put emphasis on the word together. She returned Catra's smile with her own. It was strained, she knew, but that didn't seem to matter to Catra.

Alright. They would figure it out. Whatever was going on, it could be answered at Razz's. Adora knew it!

End Notes

Once again I want to thank Lyssa for beta-reading! She actually came up with the idea to have Catra try the sword XD

If you enjoy SPOP (and if you're reading this fic, there's like a 99.99999% chance you do XD, check out her works! Also, check out my bookmarks!)

Hopefully ya'll enjoyed this! Thank you reading! Any kudos and/or comments are always appreciated as well! Writers and artists live off of comments! They let us know if you enjoyed our work!

I have more one-shots I'm working on, so if you're interested in *just* the weekly prompts (I'm not publishing them every week by the way) you can subscribe to my "Discord Prompt" series. OR, you can subscribe to my actual profile. I read a lot of SPOP fics but I am also planning on branching out into other fandoms as well (fair warning). So if you like Deltarune, Arcane, Legend of Korra, or the Last Airbender, keep an eye out!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!